Niki Birkner

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EXPERIENCE

Together AI
San Francisco, CA | August 2023 – Present

Staff Product Manager

Founding PM at hypergrowth AI infra startup (15 → 250 employees, $0 → 9-figure revenue). Own inference platform, user management, billing/commerce, developer experience, growth and product engineering.

- Led enterprise-grade org/user management system spanning users, orgs, projects, API keys; coordinated cross-service identity consolidation and RBAC framework, unblocking enterprise deals with significant ARR.
- Directed company-wide Commerce API migration across 10+ microservices, eliminating technical debt and simplifying identity primitives, catalyzing scalable pricing, audit, and governance infra, cutting support load by ~30%.
- Built dynamic pricing & commerce engine, introduced custom SKUs and customer-specific pricing APIs, delivered commercial flexibility across PLG and sales motions, generating >$10M new revenue.
- Launched dedicated inference and bring-your-own-model (BYOM) product line with custom quantization/LoRA config, now the #2 revenue driver.
- Saved $200K+ in abuse and fraud costs by architecting a real-time billing guardrail system: progressive throttling, payment capture optimizations, and system-level fraud detection.
- Launched api.together.ai Playground with long-requested features: unified models page, 30-day user analytics, multimodal playgrounds, and dashboards that serve as key entry points into the platform.
- Rebranded public-facing platform, overhauled web experience (together.ai), improved conversion and self-serve activation via redesign, content rewrite, and stronger dev tooling/documentation.

Asana
San Francisco, CA | June 2021 – August 2023

Product Manager

- Drove >$5M in ARR through iterative A/B experimentation, with wins across onboarding, team creation, and share flows.
- Launched new user profiles, the highest-performing user growth experiment of the half (+4.4% activation, +$2.6M ARR).
- Delivered a company-wide sharing and access level vision, paving the way towards a unified sharing surface across objects.
- Shipped in historically sensitive surfaces, including a full redesign of the project share modal (+5% accepted invites).
- Launched multi-select custom fields, a technically complex and cross-org initiative that became core to many enterprises.

Peregrine Technologies
San Francisco, CA | May 2020 – May 2021

Deployment Strategist

- Headed strategy and created a product roadmap for NG SCOUT, the platform powering California's Office of Emergency Services in fighting wildfires. Led need-finding, user stories, analyses, and prioritization.
- Led project implementation and sprint setup for deployments, optimizing customer relationships and team collaboration.
- Developed a cross-project virtual user training model and conducted all user training for the two largest deployments.

McKinsey & Company
San Francisco, CA | June 2019 – August 2019

Summer Business Analyst

- Facilitated operational transformation for a healthcare provider by proposing optimized work scheduling initiatives, resulting in a reduction in premium/penalty pay and an increase in productivity.

Fresquiticos
San José, Costa Rica | Sept 2016 – June 2019

Founder

- Founded and led a startup in the beverage industry, manufacturing natural, healthy sodas in LatAm. Placed products in 70+ retail outlets including two major supermarket chains. Secured $6,500 in seed funding. Gave a TED talk.

EDUCATION

Stanford University
Palo Alto, CA | Sept 2017 – Dec 2020

Bachelor of Science with Honors in Symbolic Systems · Minor in Data Science · GPA: 3.99/4.00

- Mayfield Fellow: Selected as one of 12 students for a 9-month work-study fellowship for leadership in technology.
- Stanford Women in Business President: Led a 60-person executive team for Stanford's largest women's organization.

LEADERSHIP

Co-founded **Babel**, a community of leading AI talent (engineers, researchers, and founders) with a mission to arrive and stay at the bleeding edge of AI. Assembled 100+ from Snorkel, Together AI, Perplexity, DeepMind, Meta AI, Adept AI, MosaicML, and others. Hosted events and dinners.